

3.4 Implementation and measurements

Students will be given details of an experiment carried out by an inexperienced student. Results may be included.

Candidates will be assessed on their ability to:

Implementation and measurements

- comment on the number of readings taken
 - comment on the range of measurements taken
 - comment on significant figures
 - check a reading that is inconsistent with other readings, e.g. a point that is not on the line of a graph – students may be shown a diagram of a micrometer that is being used to measure the diameter of a wire and be expected to write down the reading to the correct number of significant figures
 - comment on how the experiment may be improved, possibly by using additional apparatus (e.g. to reduce errors) – examples may include using a set square to determine whether a ruler is vertical to aid the measurement of the extension of a spring.
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